

II. Medieval History of India

Muslim Invasion of India

*Mecca is situated in Saudi Arabia. The propounder of Islam religion, **Hazrat Muhammad**, was born here in **570 A.D.**

The place is a religious pilgrimage for Islamic followers. Muhammad died in **632 A.D.** *According to Rigveda, our country is named Bharat after the name of a tribe called '**Bharat**'. According to tradition, the country was named after Dushyanta's son, 'Bharat'. *According to some scholars, the country is named after the name of Rishabhnanath's eldest son '**Bharat**'. *Iranians addressed this country as '**Hindustan**', and Greeks called it '**India**'. With respect to the people of Hind (Bharat), the word '**Hindu**' was first used by Arabians. *The first successful Muslim invasion of India took place in **712 AD** under the leadership of Arabian invader "**Muhammad-Bin Qasim**". Earlier in 712 AD, a campaign was undertaken to India under the leadership of **Ubaidullah**, but he was defeated and killed in the encounter. After a great struggle Arabians conquered Sindh in 712 AD. Sindh was ruled by **Dahir** at that time. According to Arabian texts '**Chachnama**' we came to know about the conquest of Sindh by Arabians.

Note: The year of the first successful invasion of India by Muslims is a subject of dispute among scholars. According to V.D. Mahajan, it is dated in 711 A.D. whereas according to Harishchandra Verma, it took place in 712 A.D.

*The founder of Ghaznavid Empire was **Alptigin**. Ghaznavid dynasty is also known as Yamini dynasty. Alptigin made Ghazni his capital. In 998 AD, Mahmud became the ruler of Ghazni. According to Sir Henry Elliot, Mahmud invaded India **17 times**. Mahmud Ghaznavi plundered **Somnath Temple** during the reign of **Bhimdev I (1022-63)**. *Mahmud Ghaznavi, for the first time, invaded **Chandela**s in **1019-20 AD**. At that time, the ruler of Chandela dynasty was **Vidyadhar**, who was the most powerful ruler of the dynasty.

He was the only Hindu ruler who had successfully resisted Muslim invasions. Between 1000-1027 AD, Mahmud Ghazni (Ghaznavi) attacked India 17 times, but the motive of these invasions was not to establish a stable Muslim rule in India but only to plunder the material assets. Baghdad's Caliph Al-Qadir-Billah titled Mahmud Ghaznavi as '**Yamin-ud-Daula**' and '**Amin-ul-Millah**'.

*Mahmud Ghaznavi was learned and gentle. He respected scholars and artists. He gathered famous scholars in Ghazni at that time. **Utbi** was his court historian. He wrote texts like '**Kitab-ul-Yamini**' and '**Tarikh-i-Yamini**'. Other prominent members of his court were **Albiruni**, **Baihaqi**-writer of **Tarikh-i-Subuktigin**, Persian poet **Uzari**, **Tusi** and **Unsuri**, **Asjadi** and **Farrukhi**. *The author of **Shahnama** is **Firdausi**. He was a famous court poet of Mahmud Ghaznavi. He earned the titled of 'Homer of the East'. **Firishta** (1560-1620 A.D.) wrote books like **Tarikh-i-Firishta** or **Gulshan-i- Ibrahimi**. His full name was **Muhammad Qasim Hindu Shah** Astarabadi **Firishta** His book '**Tarikh-i-Firishta**' is dedicated to the ruler of Bijapur Ibrahim Adil Shah II. In the 11th century, **Al-Biruni** came to India with Mahmud Ghaznavi. From his book '**Kitab-ul-hind**' we come to know about the social and cultural conditions of contemporary India. *Al-Biruni was the first Muslim to study Puranas. He was born in **973 AD** and was a resident of Khiva (ancient Khwarizm). He came to India with Mahmud Ghaznavi. Al-Biruni was not only a historian, his knowledge and interest included Astronomy, Geography, logic, medicine, mathematics, religion and theology. He studied Sanskrit, including many literary works of Brahmagupta, Balabhadra and Varahmihira are outlined especially. Al-Biruni wrote '**Tahqiq-i-Hind**' in the Arabic language. * Edward Sachau translated this text from Arabic into English language. It was translated into Hindi by Rajnikant Sharma. Mahmud Ghaznavi introduced silver coins with Sanskrit legend. The two sides of the silver coin were marked with the legend in two different languages. The legend on the upper side was inscribed in the Arabic language, and the other side was inscribed in the Sanskrit language (Devnagari Script). In the middle part of the coin was written in Sanskrit language - "Avyaktmekam Muhammad Avatar Nripati Mahmud". *The ruler of Central Asia, **Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori** first invaded India in 1175 AD. In 1178 AD, Muhammad Ghori invaded Gujarat, but Mularaja-II or Bhimdev-II, under the leadership of his qualified and courageous widowed mother Naika Devi fought and defeated Ghori near Mount Abu. It was the first defeat of Ghori in India. *In **1191 AD**, Prithviraj Chauhan and Ghori fought the first **battle of Tarain**. In 1192 AD, Muhammad Ghori defeated Prithviraj Chauhan in the second battle of Tarain, establishing the Muslim power in India. Ghori's alertness and skilled battle techniques were the main factors in the victory

of the Muslims. Prithviraj Chauhan while trying to escape, was caught near Sursati (modern Sirsa, Haryana). *For the death of Prithviraj Chauhan different opinions were given, but among those opinions, the opinion of Hasan Nizami is widely accepted, which says that Prithviraj Chauhan went to Ajmer with Ghori, and accepted the allegiance of Ghori, but when tried to conspire for a revolt, he was then awarded the death penalty. This battle was the most important battle in Indian History. *In **1194 AD**, Muhammad Ghori defeated Kannauj's Gahadavala King **Jayachandra** in the **battle of Chandawar**. Chandawar is situated in present Firozabad district (U.P.) near banks of Yamuna. *Coins issued by Ghori had image of **Goddess Laxmi** on one side and **Kalma** was inscribed in Arabic on the other. *Soon after the victories of Muhammad Ghori '**Iqta system**' was introduced in Northern India. *Muhammad Ghori appointed **Qutb Al-Din Aybak, (also spelled Qutbuddin Aibak, Qutb-Ud-Din-Aybak)** in 1192 AD as incharge of his Indian territories. He played a significant role in the second battle of Tarain of 1192 AD. Pleased with his works, Ghori appointed him the administrator of Kuhram and Samana. He controlled the administration of Northern parts of India as Ghori's representative till 1206 AD. In this period, Aybak expanded the Turkish power in Northern India. *Ghori or Aybak never thought of conquering Bihar and Bengal. The task was accomplished by an ordinary slave of Muhammad Ghori named **Ikhtiyar-ud-din** Muhammad-Bin Bakhtiyar Khalji (1193 A.D. to 1203 A.D. mid). He occupied the capital Odantapuri by conquering Bihar and destroyed Nalanda and Vikramshila. He invaded Bengal from 1198 A.D. to 1203 A.D. At that time the ruler there was **Lakshmana Sena**. He left the place without actually fighting the battle. Turkish army plundered the people entering the capital city of Nadia. In the absence of the king, the city surrendered. Escaping from there Lakshmana Sena took refuge in East Bengal and ruled there for some time. *Bakhtiyar Khalji did not try to conquer complete Bengal. He made **Lakhnauti** his capital. *According to Professor Habib, the victory of **North-Western** province by **Turks** had given birth to '**Urban Revolution**' and '**Rural Revolution**' respectively.

1. Hazrat Muhammad, the Prophet, was born in the year:

- (a) 570 A.D. (b) 622 A.D.
(c) 642 A.D. (d) 670 A.D.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (a)

Hazrat Muhammad was born approximately in 570 A.D. in the Saudi Arabian city of Mecca. He is known as the "Holy Prophet" to Muslims. He died in 632 A.D.

2. Where is Mecca?

- (a) Syria (b) Iran
(c) Iraq (d) Saudi Arabia

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

See the explanation of above question.

3. The word 'Hindu' as a reference to the people of Hind (India) was first used by:

- (a) The Greeks (b) The Romans
(c) The Chinese (d) The Arabs

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

Most scholars feel that the name "Hindu" was pronounced by invaders who could not pronounce the name of the Indus River. As mentioned in Rigveda, Bharata is defined as 'Sapta Sindhu.' Iranians termed this country as Hindustan, and Greeks called it 'India.' About the Indian people, the word 'Hindu' was first used by Arabians.

4. First Muslim attack on India occurred in the year

- (a) 674 (b) 1013
(c) 711 (d) None of these

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

King Dahir of Sindh fought the battle with Muhammad-Bin-Qasim, the first successful Muslim invader who defeated Dahir in this battle. He arrived at the coast of Sindh in 712 A.D. (Now in Pakistan) and was successful in defeating and killing Dahir.

Note : There is a dispute about the exact date of the first successful Muslim invasion of India. According to V.D. Mahajan, this date is 711 A.D. but according to Harish Chandra Verma, this date is 712 A.D.

5. When Muhammad-Bin-Qasim conquered Sindh

- (a) 173 A.D. (b) 716 A.D.
(c) 712 A.D. (d) 719 A.D.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question

6. First Muslim invader in India was

- (a) Qutbuddin Aybak
(b) Muhammad Ghazni
(c) Muhammad-Bin-Qasim
(d) Muhammad Ghori

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

The first successful Muslim invader of India was Muhammad-Bin-Qasim. In the beginning of the 8th century A.D., under the leadership of Muhammad Bin-Qasim, a part of India was unsuccessfully attacked. The empire of Arabs couldn't spread towards the east of Sindh and Multan, and it gradually declined. In the words of Dr. Stanley Lane-Poole "Although Arabs conquered Sindh, but it remained only an episode in history of India and Islam. This was an incomplete victory". Their incomplete task was done by Turks.

7. The first Muslim invaders of India were –

- (a) The Ghaznavids (b) The Ghurids
(c) The Arabs (d) None of the above

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

The very first successful Muslim invasion of India took place in Sindh in the year 712 A.D. by the Arabs under the leadership of Muhammad-Bin-Qasim. He displaced Raja Dahir, who ruled Sindh from his capital, Arod (near modern Karachi).

8. Muhammad-Bin-Qasim was a –

- (a) Turk (b) Mongol
(c) Arab (d) Turk-Afghan

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (c)

Muhammad-Bin-Qasim was an Arab ruler born around 695 A.D. He was the nephew and son-in-law of Iraq's King Al-Hajjaj. At the age of seventeen, he was sent by Caliph-al-Walid to lead an army to Sindh (India).

9. According to Chachnama, what was the Capital of the Indus Country in the 6th and 7th century?

- (a) Deval (b) Arod
(c) Lodawa (d) Barmer

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre.) 2020

Ans (b)

Chachnama ("Story of Chach") is one of the main historical sources for the history of Sindh in the 7th to 8th century A.D., written in Arabic. It takes its name from Raja Chach of Sindh whose son Dahir stood against Muhammad Bin Qasim's invasion of Sindh in 8th Century A.D. Text states that Arod served as capital of the Indus country in the 6th and 7th century A.D. Hence option (b) is correct.

10. "Chachnama" was translated to Persian by

- (a) Nurrudin Muhammad Aufi
(b) Shams-i-Siraj
(c) Muhammad Ali Bin Abu Bakr Kufi
(d) More than one of the above

70th B.P.S.C. Pre-2024

Ans. (c)

The Persian translation of Chachnama was done by Muhammad Ali bin Abu Bakr Kufi. Chachnama is a book written in the Arabic language, but there is no clear information available about the author of this book. Chachnama describes the history of Sindh from 680 to 718 A.D. The complete translation of this book from Persian to English was done in 1900 A.D. by Mirza Kalich Beg.

11. Who among the following was the founder of Ghaznavid dynasty?

- (a) Alptigin (b) Mahmud
(c) Sebuktigin (d) Ismail

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Towards the end of the ninth century, Trans-oxiana, Khurasan and parts of Iran were being ruled by the Samanids who were Iranian by descent. Among the Samanid governors there was a Turkish Slave, Alptigin, who, in course of time, established an independent kingdom with its capital at Ghazni and founded Ghaznavid dynasty, which soon took over the control of Samanid Kingdom.

12. Assertion (A) : Mohd. Ghazni invaded India seventeen times.

Reason (R) : He wanted to establish permanent Muslim Empire in India.

Select the correct answer from the given codes :

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
(b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
(c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
(d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Turkish conqueror Mahmud of Ghazni succeeded his father in 998 A.D. He established a huge empire in Central Asia with its capital at Ghazni (Afghanistan). For 17 times, he attacked India from 1000 to 1027 A.D. He was a ruthless invader and plunderer of wealth. In these invasions, his aim was not to establish any permanent Muslim rule in India but to take away the huge wealth of the country.

13. Which of the following Chandela Kings was not defeated by Mahmud Ghaznavi –

- (a) Dhunaga (b) Vidyadhar
(c) Jaishakti (d) Danga

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

The Chandela dynasty is famous in Indian history for the King Vidyadhar, who repulsed the attacks of Mahmud Ghaznavi during 1019-20 A.D. From the ninth century to the 13th century, the Chandelas ruled over Central India. Their first capital city was Khajuraho, which was later shifted to Mahoba.

14. Which Chandela King faced Mahmud Ghaznavi?

- (a) Kumarpal (b) Bhim II
(c) Vidyadhar (d) Arunoraja

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

15. Who was the court historian of Mahmud of Ghazni –

- (a) Hassan Nizami (b) Utbi
(c) Firdausi (d) Chand Bardai

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (b)

Mahmud of Ghazni was just a plunderer who mounted at least 17 raids in India. But in his kingdom in Afghanistan, he had shown love for art and culture. He patronized three persons:

- Firdausi (Persian Poet, known as Homer of the East) who wrote Shahnama.
- Albiruni (a brilliant scholar from Central Asia) who wrote Tahqiq-I-Hind.
- Utbi (court historian), who wrote Kitab-ul-Yamni and Tarikh-i-Yamini.

16. Farista, the author of Shah-nama was associated with the court of

- (a) Subuktigin (b) Mahmud Ghazanavi
(c) Muhammad Ghori (d) Alaptigin

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2013

Ans. (*)

The given question is incorrect because the writer of Shahnama is Firdausi, not Firishta. Firdausi was a scholar-poet of the Mahmud of Ghazni court. He was also known to be popular as the 'Homer' of the east. So option (b) should be the correct answer. Firishta wrote an authentic book Tareekh-i Firista. His full name was Muhammad Qasim Hindushah Astarabadi Firishta. For some time, he lived in Murtza Nizam Shah's court in Ahmadnagar. After that, he went to Bijapur. His book Tarikh-i Firishta was devoted to the emperor of Bijapur, Ibrahim Adil Shah II.

17. Who was the author of 'Shahnama'?

- (a) Utbi (b) Firdausi
(c) Al-Beruni (d) Barani

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

18. The first Muslim who studied Puranas was –

- (a) Abul Fazal (b) Abdul Qadir Badayuni
(c) Al-Biruni (d) Dara Shikoh

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

Al-Biruni was the first Muslim to study Puranas. He was not only a historian, but he also took a keen interest in a wide range of subjects e.g. Astronomy, Geography, Medicine, Mathematics, Reasoning, Religion and Theology. Due to his interests, he was attracted towards gaining knowledge of the religious culture of then India. He studied Sanskrit and used many references in his creations, mainly from the works of Brahmagupta, Balabhadra and Varahamihira.

19. The famous historian who visited India with Mahmud of Ghazni was –

- (a) Ferishta (b) Al-Beruni
(c) Afif (d) Ibn Battuta

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (b)

During 11th century A.D. Al-Biruni, the father of Indian Historical writing accompanied Mahmud of Ghazni to India and stayed here for many years. Al-Biruni translated Patanjali's Yoga-Sutra into Arabic (called Kitab Patanjali) but Tahqiq-I-Hind (Reality of Hindustan) was his most important work in which he gave a socio-cultural description of India.

20. Al-Beruni came to India in –

- (a) 9th century A.D. (b) 10th century A.D.
(c) 11th century A.D. (d) 12th Century A.D.

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Pre) 2010

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

21. Which scholar came to India with Mahmud Ghazni –

- (a) Ibn Battuta (b) Al-Beruni
(c) Amir Khusrau (d) Ferishta

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

22. Which one of the following statements about Alberuni is not correct?

- (a) He was a secular author
(b) His writing was influenced by India
(c) He was a Sanskrit Scholar
(d) He was an expert of trigonometry

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (a)

Al-Biruni was born in 973 A.D. in the territory of Khwarizm, now called Khiva, in Central Asia. He was not a secular writer because Al-biruni never gave any sympathetic reference to the contemporary event of Somnath temple raid by Mahmud of Ghazni in 1025/1026.

23. After the attack of Mahmud Ghazni, who among the following reconstructed the Somnath temple?

- (a) Bhimraja-I (b) Bhimdeva
(c) Mularaja (d) Jayasingh Siddhiraj

Jharkhand P.S.C. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

Bhimadeva was the ruler during the attack of Mahmud Ghazni on Somnath Temple (1025/26 AD). After Ghazni left with the loot of Somnath, Bhimadeva-I reconstructed the temple.

24. The Prime Minister recently inaugurated the new Circuit House near Somnath Temple at veraval. Which of the following statements are correct regarding Somnath Temple?

1. Somnath Temple is one of the Jyotirlinga shrines.
2. A description of Somnath Temple was given by Al-Biruni.
3. Pran Pratishtha of Somnath Temple (installation of the present day temple) was done by President S. Radhakrishnan.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

Somnath temple is situated in Gujarat State on the banks of Arabian Sea. It is one of the 12 Jyotirlingas. Al-Biruni has described this temple in his travelogue. India's first president Dr. Rajendra Prasad was present at the Pran Pratishtha of present day Somnath temple.

25. Who among the following issued silver coins with Sanskrit legend on one side:

- (a) Muhammad-Bin-Qasim
(b) Mahmud of Ghazni
(c) Sher Shah
(d) Akbar

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

The silver coins introduced by Mahmud Ghazni were struck in India with Arabic and Sanskrit inscriptions on both sides.

26. Which one of the following rulers from Central Asia conquered North India in 1192?

- (a) Jalaluddin Mankbarni
(b) Mahmud of Ghazni
(c) Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori
(d) Genghis Khan

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

Ans. (c)

Shihabuddin Muhammad Ghori, the ruler of Central Asia, conquered north India in 1192 A.D. The first attack of Muhammad Ghori took place in 1175 A.D. on Multan. He attacked **Multan and Uch in 1175-76 A.D.** and **Gujarat in 1178 A.D.** In 1191 A.D., he fought the first battle of Tarain with Prithviraj Chauhan and was defeated. In the **Second Battle** of Tarain (1192 A.D.), Prithviraj was defeated by Ghori, and in this way, a central Muslim political system was established, which lasted for many years.

27. Who defeated Muhammad Ghori for the first time?

- (a) Mularaja- II (b) Prithviraj Chauhan
(c) Jai Chand (d) Prithviraj-II

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (a)

The first battle of Muhammad Ghori was against a Hindu ruler Mularaja-II or Bhimadev-II of Gujarat. Mularaja-II or Bhimadev-II, was a young man, and real regent was his mother, Naika Devi. She inflicted a major defeat on Muhammad Ghori and hence, Ghori never tried to attack India from Gujarat's side.

28. In which battle Muhammad Ghori defeated Jayachandra-

- (a) Battle of Tarain (1191 A.D.)
(b) Battle of Tarain (1192 A.D.)
(c) Battle of Chandawar (1194 A.D.)
(d) Battle of Kannauj (1194 A.D.)

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Muhammad Ghori defeated the king of Kannauj, Jayachandra in the battle of Chandawar during 1194 A.D. This battle was fought in Chandawar (In Modern Firozabad district in U.P.), on the bank of Yamuna River close to Agra.

29. Which one of the following kings was defeated by Muhammad Ghori in the battle of Chandawar?

- (a) Prithviraj Chauhan (b) Jayachandra
(c) Kumarpala (d) Bhima- II

U.P.R.O./ A.R.O. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

30. Whom had Muhammad Ghori defeated in 1194 in the Battle of Chandawar?

- (a) Kumarpal (b) Jaichand
(c) Govindraj (d) Bhim II

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

31. Battle that laid the foundation of Muslim domination in India was :

- (a) First Battle of Tarain
- (b) Second Battle of Tarain
- (c) First Battle of Panipat
- (d) Second Battle of Panipat

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The second battle of Tarain was fought between Muhammad Ghori and Rajput army of Prithviraj Chauhan. The battle took place in 1192 AD near Tarain. In this battle, Prithviraj Chauhan was defeated by Muhammad Ghori. After this battle, the Muslim power was strongly enrooted in northern India, which may be regarded as a turning point in Indian history.

32. Arrange the following names chronologically and select correct answer from the codes given below:

1. Genghis Khan
2. Mahmud Ghaznavi
3. Muhammad Ghori
4. Taimur

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4
- (b) 2, 3, 1, 4
- (c) 3, 4, 1, 2
- (d) 4, 1, 2, 3

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Mains) 2008

Ans. (b)

During 1000-1027 A.D. Mahmud Ghaznavi attacked India for 17 times. Muhammad Ghori's first attack occurred in 1175 A.D. and then he attacked again and again to expand his empire until 1205 A.D. The fear of Genghis (Changiz) Khan's attack haunted India when he was chasing son of the fugitive ruler of Khwarizm Shah, Jalaluddin Mingburni in 1221 A.D. Taimur attacked India in 1398 A.D.

33. Coins of which Muslim ruler bear an image of Devi Lakshmi?

- (a) Muhammad Ghori
- (b) Alauddin Khalji
- (c) Akbar
- (d) None of the above

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (a)

Coins issued by Ghori have an image of Goddess Lakshmi, while on the opposite side of the coin, Kalma was inscribed in Arabic.

34. Muhammad Ghori granted first Iqta in India to –

- (a) Tajuddin Yalduj
- (b) Qutbuddin Aybak
- (c) Shamsuddin Iltutmish
- (d) Nazir-ud-din Qubacha

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (b)

Soon after the victories of Muhammad Ghori, Iqta system was established in North India. In 1192 A.D., Muhammad Sam of Ghori (Muhammad Ghori) appointed Qutb-ud-din-Aybak, as in charge of his Indian territories. He played an important role in the second battle of Tarain. Pleased with his works, Ghori appointed him the administrator of Kuhram and Samana. He had taken care of the administration of North Indian territories conquered by them as representative of Ghori till 1206. During this period, Aibak also expanded Turkish power in northern India.

35. Which slave of Muhammad Ghori conquered Bengal and Bihar –

- (a) Qutbudin Aybak
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Bakhtiyar Khalji
- (d) Yalduj

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (c)

Muhammad Ghori and Aybak didn't ever think of conquering Bihar and Bengal. This task was accomplished by their ordinary slave Ikhtiyar Uddin Muhammad-Bin-Bakhtiyar Khalji. Between 1193 and 1203 AD, he conquered Bihar and destroyed Vikramshila, Nalanda and captured the capital Odantpur. He attacked Bengal between 1198 and 1203, where its ruler Lakshman Sen fled away without fighting in the battlefield. Turkish army entered the capital Nadiya and resorted to massive loot. In the absence of the King, the city surrendered. Lakshman Sen had taken refuge in East Bengal and ruled there for sometime. Bakhtiyar Khalji did not try to conquer the whole of the Bengal. Bakhtiyar Khalji made his capital in Lakhnauti.

36. Who was the first Muslim conqueror of Bihar?

- (a) Malik Ibrahim
- (b) Iltutmish
- (c) Bakhtiyar Khalji
- (d) Ali Mardan Khalji
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

60th to 62nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above question.

37. Who was the real founder of Turk rule in Bihar?

- (a) Malik Husamuddin
- (b) Ibn Bakhtiyar Khilji
- (c) Ibrahim
- (d) Dariya Khan Noohani
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2022

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of above question.

38. Nalanda Vihar was destroyed by :

- (a) Bakhtiyar Khalji
- (b) Qutubddin Aibak
- (c) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
- (d) Alauddin Khalji
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above